

Joomla: The No. 1 open source CMS

Joomla, one of the world's most popular open source content management systems (CMS), has won the Packt Publishing award for the top open source CMS. The Packt Open Source Award is a coveted honour for an open source project. The awards are decided on the basis of public voting and inputs by a panel of judges comprising luminaries from the open source world.

It is the third such award for Joomla. It previously won the same award, the Packt Open Source CMS Award, in 2006, and also won the Packt Best PHP Open Source CMS Award 2007.

Centre to promote FOSS at the national level; seeks tips from Kerala

The Centre seems to be keen on taking the Free and Open Source Software (FOSS)-based initiatives to the national level. It has reportedly asked Kerala to provide it with open software tips, which can be used by the government to popularise its use at the national level.

The Department of Information Technology (DIT) has approached the International Centre for Free and Open Source Software (ICFOSS) to seek help in this regard. As per its IT policy, Kerala aims to support the use of FOSS in all projects, especially those for e-governance. One of the first states in the country to adapt to free software, Kerala is also working to maintain its leadership position and ICFOSS (launched in February 2011) is a step in this direction.

The state government has introduced FOSS in schools through the IT@School programme. The programme introduces specific FOSS-based ICT training programmes for students who require special attention. It has been developed entirely on GCompris, a FOSS-based application. The IT@School project aims to empower the teachers and students of the state with ICT skills. Kerala also recently insisted on the use of FOSS-based software for Aadhaar (a 12-digit unique number) enrolment.

Order drinks with your Android device

Now, this is some way to get your drinks ready. Not exactly a robot, but iZac—the Android bartender device—does mix precision cocktails at great speed! The creator of the device, Nick Johnson, has used a Motorola Xoom and a custom open source app to create it. The users can choose any three drinks and even use the 'I'm feeling lucky' button to get a mix of three random drinks.

There are two rotating platforms that contain all the alcohol and mixers necessary for a host of drinks. The device starts rotating after a glass is kept between the platforms and dispenses the drinks. Johnson has used an aquarium pump to pressurise the beakers and also a pinch valve that controls the flow of the liquid while dispensing the drinks. The pinch valve helps the liquid to reach the spout of the tube quickly.



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